STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	AU-4200

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 10/10/07	DATE REVISED 02/01/24	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: CRISIS NEGOTIATIONS UNIT	RESOURCES
SUBJECT SARPY COUNTY CRISIS NEGOTIATIONS UNIT STRUCTURE	CROSS REFERENCE G-1220 CHAIN OF COMMAND G-5230 TRANSFER AND ASSIGNMENT P-5000 HIGH RISK INCIDENTS P-5010 HIGH RISK INCIDENT COMMAND

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the direct lines of supervision and responsibility for the Sarpy County Crisis Negotiations Unit and to establish the chain of command.

II. Policy:

A. The Sarpy County Crisis Negotiations Unit (CNU) shall be under the direct command of the Crisis Negotiations Unit Commander who shall have the rank of lieutenant or higher. The CNU Commander shall be appointed by the Executive Board as written in the Inter-local Cooperation Agreement signed on 4/2/2019.

1. The CNU Commander or his/her designee shall be responsible for maintaining accurate records for the CNU Unit, including, but not limited to, selection, training, after-action reports and any other records deemed necessary by the CNU Commander.

2. The CNU Commander shall research and list equipment needs and priorities and submit recommendations for purchases.

3. The CNU Commander shall ensure all vehicles assigned to the CNU Unit are fully functional and shall coordinate maintenance as needed.

4. The CNU Commander shall monitor the performance of all members and document any significant performance issues.

B. Other Positions and Duties:

1. **Team Leader:** the Team Leader, who shall generally have the rank of Sergeant or higher, shall be in charge of other CNU members at the scene when the CNU Commander is in the Command Post. The Team Leader shall be under the direction of the CNU Commander.

2. **Primary Negotiator:** the Primary Negotiator will be that qualified, trained negotiator who shall be responsible for all direct communication with the subject during the duration of the incident. Primary Negotiators may be rotated due to reasons of fatigue or non-rapport with the subject.

3. **Secondary Negotiator:** the Secondary Negotiator will be that qualified, trained negotiator who shall assist the Primary Negotiator with determining strategies, assist in coaching, and will act as a buffer between other team members and the Primary Negotiator.

4. **Scribe:** the Scribe will be that member responsible for all note taking, documentation, and dissemination of noteworthy information throughout the incident.

5. **Intelligence Personnel:** the Intelligence Personnel will be those members who are delegated to perform all intelligence gathering throughout an incident. This includes, but is not limited to:

   a. Background gathering
   b. Conducting records checks
   c. Interviewing witnesses
   d. Set up/tear down of equipment

6. **Psychologist:** Mental health support may be rendered by a qualified, trained mental health professional for crisis incidents. Psychological support may serve negotiators with a professional, objective opinion regarding the mental state of the subject through the monitoring of communications between the Primary Negotiator and the subject.

C. In the absence of the CNU Commander, one of the two Team Leaders shall be in command of the Unit.

D. Individual Crisis Negotiations Unit members (negotiators) may be assigned supervision over other unit members during incidents and training. This assignment shall be made by the Unit Commander or a Team Leader. This assignment may be made without regard to formal rank, and those CNU members placed under the supervision of another CNU member shall follow the direction of that individual in accordance with Sarpy County CNU policies regardless of rank (see G-1220 Chain of Command).

E. Under specific circumstances, the CNU Commander may be under the command of the High Risk Incident Commander as provided in policy (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents and P-5010 High Risk Incident Command).

F. Deputies/Officers selected for an assignment to the CNU shall do so on a part-time basis with, or beyond, the normally assigned duties of their position. As such,

supervision for day-to-day activities shall be provided within the chain of command of those deputies/officers assigned Departments/Divisions.

G. CNU members must be prepared for call-out at any time:

1. Each CNU member shall be shall be available by telephone at all times.

2. When called out, unit members shall respond appropriately and proceed per instructions to the designated location.

3. If a CNU member will be unavailable for call-out for a period of time exceeding twenty-four (24) hours (e.g. member is on vacation, will be out of town for training, etc.), he or she shall notify the CNU Commander.

H. Participation of CNU members in CNU related training shall be contingent upon the approval of their Department/Division commanders and with timely notification of immediate supervisors. Overtime may be paid to allow attendance.

I. **CNU member Selection:** see also G-5230 Transfer and Assignment.

1. Each applicant shall interview for open positions with the Commander, Team Leaders and/or the Commanders designee.

2. Minimum Requirements: The following requirements must be met to apply for a position in the Crisis Negotiations Unit.

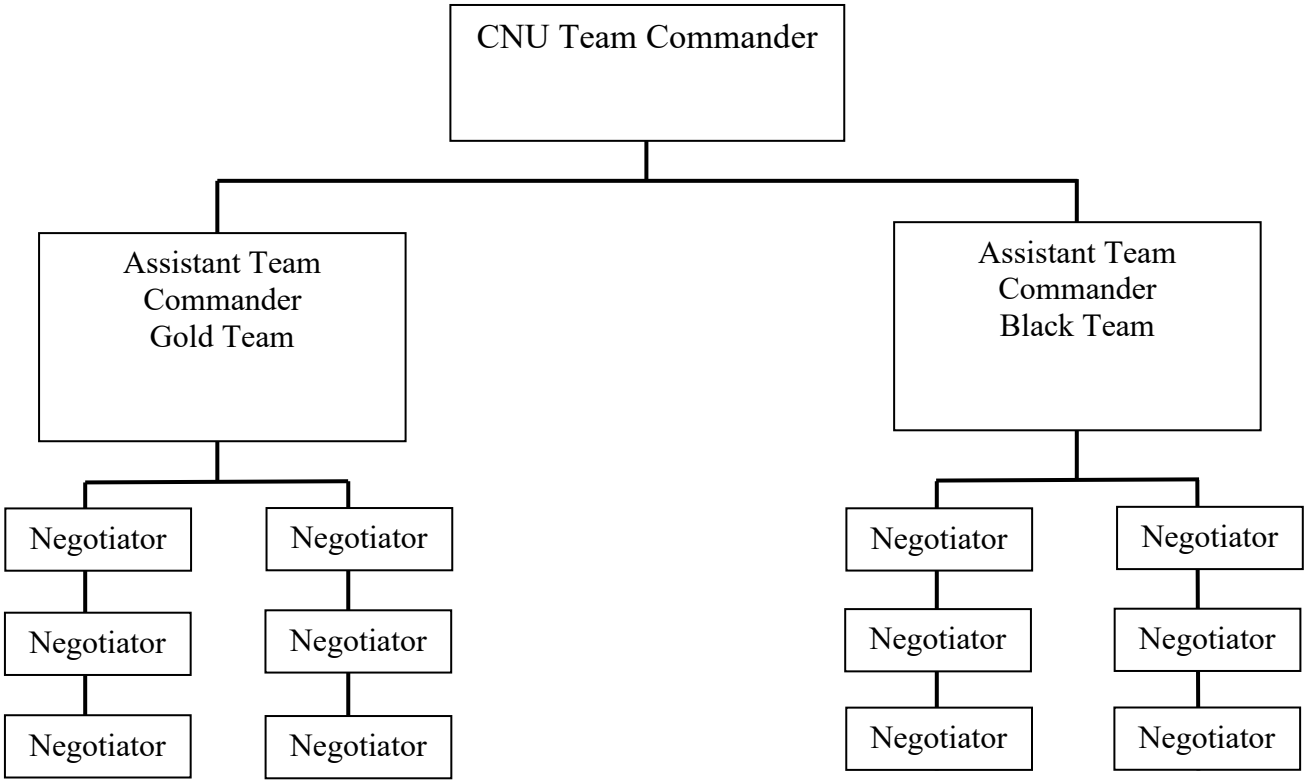
3. Must have at least one (1) year of experience as a deputy/officer with the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office, the La Vista Police Department, or the Papillion Police Department, or the equivalent with another law enforcement agency.

a) Must have successfully completed FTO.

b) Availability for emergency call-out at any time.

c) Must be highly self-motivated and able to work individually and as a team.

d) Must have excellent verbal communication and active listening skills.

4. Training: An applicant may be provided a probationary position pending successful completion of an approved Crisis Negotiations training program.

Crisis Negotiations Unit Structure